

Event Information:

EventID :
79
Event Time :
Mar, 15, 2021, 09:30 PM
Rule :
SOC119 - Proxy - Malicious Executable File Detected
Level :
Security Analyst
Source Address :
172.16.20.5
Source Hostname :
PentestMachine
Destination Address :
140.82.121.4
Destination Hostname :
github.com
Username :
kali
Request URL :
<https://github.com/BloodHoundAD/BloodHound/releases>
User Agent :
Penetration Test - Do not Contain
Device Action :
Allowed

Analysis Steps:

The claims of this being a pen test visible in the alert immediately stand out but this must be verified. As such emails were searched, filtered to the relevant time-frame.

Result: 4 Mails				
Date	Sender	Recipients	Subject	Final Action
Apr, 04, 2021, 11:00 PM	lethuyan852@gmail.com	mark@letsdefend.io	Its a Must have for your Phone	Unknown
Mar, 21, 2021, 12:26 PM	aaronluo@cmail.carleton.ca	mark@letsdefend.io	COVID19 Vaccine	Unknown
Mar, 07, 2021, 05:31 PM	katharine@letsdefend.io	katharine.isabell@yandex.ru	Blank	Unknown
Mar, 07, 2021, 04:45 PM	aaronluo@cmail.carleton.ca	nicolas@letsdefend.io	Invoice	Unknown

But no email could be found stating penetration testing activities are to be conducted and as such it must be taken into consideration that this could be an attacker posing as performing legitimate Red Team activities.

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a False Positive which requires escalation and additional verification.

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a False Positive classification for the download of a dual-use security tool, paired with a mandatory escalation for verification. The internal host PentestMachine downloaded BloodHound, an Active Directory mapping utility, from an external repository. While the hostname and User Agent strongly suggest internal penetration testing, no explicit email authorisation was found during the investigation. The incident is classified as a False Positive to avoid disrupting legitimate operations, but it is being escalated for verification.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC119 - Proxy - Malicious Executable File Detected
- **Source Host:** PentestMachine (172[.]16.20.5)
- **Target Domain:** github[.]com (140[.]82.121.4)
- **User Account:** kali
- **Device Action:** Allowed

Analysis and Evidence

- **Activity Breakdown:** Proxy logs show the internal host connecting to `hxxps://github[.]com/BloodHoundAD/BloodHound/releases`.
- **Payload Identification:** BloodHound is a tool that can be used legitimately for security audits or maliciously to map out network vulnerabilities.
- **Evasion / Masquerading Potential:** The web request utilised a custom User Agent reading Penetration Test - Do not Contain. While this may be a legitimate flag from internal staff, an external threat actor could also easily spoof this User Agent to evade containment.

Threat Intelligence

- **Internal Correlation:** A review of email communications yielded four results for the relevant time-frame, but none contained authorisation for a scheduled penetration test.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed proxy logs to identify the downloaded executable (BloodHound) and the destination domain.
2. Reviewed email logs to find official authorisation for the penetration test, which yielded no results.
3. Determined that while indicators point to authorised activity, the lack of communication requires verification without immediately disrupting potential Red Team operations.
4. Declared the alert a False Positive to reflect the likely planned nature of the activity.
5. Escalated for immediate verification with the Red Team to ensure the activity on 172[.]16.20.5 is officially sanctioned.

Let's Defend Result

SOC119 - Proxy - Malicious Executable File Detected

False Positive (+5 Point)

Has Anyone Accessed IP/URL/Domain? (+5 Point)

Analyze URL Address (+5 Point)